

LOVE-ALL FOR THE GAME

As a youngster, Aisam-ul-Haq Qureshi was involved in multiple sports, but when his mother took him to a tennis session during one of the summer breaks, little did he know that he would go on to become one of the **icons of tennis.**

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It's a rainy and cold afternoon in Islamabad, but it's business as usual for Aisam-ul-Haq Qureshi. As president of the Pakistan Tennis Federation, he has had a long day — a meeting with the office-bearers, followed by some important discussions with a few stakeholders, and then a regular update on how the players are adapting to the new training regime.

But in between the meetings, he makes it a point to show us around the PTF-SDA Tennis Complex and share his vision. Despite hailing from a family of sporting icons — **his grandfather Khawaja Iftikhar Ahmed was a tennis legend, having played for both India and Pakistan, and his mother, Nosheen Ihtsham, was Pakistan's No.1 tennis player for 10 years** — things weren't easy for Qureshi as he strived to become a flag-bearer of tennis in a country that swears by cricket.

Having done the hard yards for years, he knows what challenges a young player faces while pursuing the sport. With that in mind, he wants to support the players to the hilt and produce a Grand Slam champion.



« I've been in touch with the ITF and ATP so that we can host Futures and Challenger tournaments here [in Pakistan], as they would be a game-changer for the sport in our country; it would give everyone a road map to start thinking big — Aisam-ul-Haq Qureshi »